

Production Readiness Checklist

Last Updated: January 2025

Status: Pre-Launch Review

This checklist covers all remaining steps before going live with HeirVault.

🚫 CRITICAL (Must Complete Before Launch)

1. Environment Variables Configuration

Production Environment (Vercel)

- ☐ **Database**
 - ☐ `DATABASE_URL` - Production Supabase pooled connection (port 6543)
 - ☐ `PRISMA_ACCELERATE_URL` - Production Prisma Accelerate URL (optional but recommended)
- ☐ **Authentication (Clerk)**
 - ☐ `NEXT_PUBLIC_CLERK_PUBLISHABLE_KEY` - Production Clerk publishable key
 - ☐ `CLERK_SECRET_KEY` - Production Clerk secret key
 - ☐ Configure production domain in Clerk dashboard
 - ☐ Add production domain to Clerk allowed origins
- ☐ **Application URLs**
 - ☐ `NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL` - Production domain (e.g., `https://heirvault.app`)
 - ☐ `APP_URL` - Production domain (same as above)
- ☐ **Email (Resend)**
 - ☐ `RESEND_API_KEY` - Production Resend API key
 - ☐ `RESEND_FROM_EMAIL` - Production sender email (e.g., `noreply@heirvault.app`)
 - ☐ Verify domain in Resend dashboard
 - ☐ Set up SPF/DKIM records for email deliverability
- ☐ **Admin Access**
 - ☐ `ADMIN_EMAILS` - Comma-separated list of admin emails
 - ☐ `BOOTSTRAP_ADMIN_EMAIL` - Initial admin email (optional)
 - ☐ `ADMIN_USER_IDS` - Comma-separated list of admin user IDs (optional)
- ☐ **Security**
 - ☐ `HEIRVAULT_TOKEN_SECRET` - Long random string for HMAC signing (32+ characters)
- ☐ **Stripe (if billing enabled)**
 - ☐ `STRIPE_SECRET_KEY` - Production Stripe secret key (starts with `sk_live_`)

- ☐ `NEXT_PUBLIC_STRIPE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY` - Production Stripe publishable key (starts with `pk_live_`)
- ☐ `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` - Production webhook secret
- ☐ Configure webhook endpoint in Stripe dashboard
- ☐ Test webhook delivery
- ☐ **Optional Services**
 - ☐ `SENTRY_DSN` - Sentry error tracking (already configured)
 - ☐ `SENTRY_AUTH_TOKEN` - For source map uploads
 - ☐ `SENTRY_ORG` - Sentry organization slug
 - ☐ `SENTRY_PROJECT` - Sentry project slug
 - ☐ `OPENAI_API_KEY` - If using AI features (optional)

2. Database Setup

- ☐ **Production Database**
 - ☐ Create production Supabase project
 - ☐ Run all Prisma migrations: `npx prisma migrate deploy`
 - ☐ Verify schema matches: `npx prisma migrate status`
 - ☐ Generate Prisma Client: `npx prisma generate`
 - ☐ Test database connection from production environment
- ☐ **Database Backups**
 - ☐ Enable automatic backups in Supabase
 - ☐ Test backup restoration process
 - ☐ Document backup retention policy
- ☐ **Database Security**
 - ☐ Enable Row Level Security (RLS) if using Supabase
 - ☐ Review and test database connection security
 - ☐ Verify SSL/TLS is enforced

3. Domain & SSL Configuration

- ☐ **Domain Setup**
 - ☐ Purchase/configure production domain (e.g., `heirvault.app`)
 - ☐ Configure DNS records in Vercel
 - ☐ Verify domain ownership
 - ☐ Set up custom domain in Vercel project settings
- ☐ **SSL/TLS**
 - ☐ Verify SSL certificate is automatically provisioned by Vercel
 - ☐ Test HTTPS enforcement
 - ☐ Verify HSTS header is working

4. Legal & Compliance

- ☐ **Legal Pages** ☒ (Already Created)
 - ☒ Privacy Policy (</legal/privacy>)
 - ☒ Terms of Service (</legal/terms>)
 - ☒ Legal Disclaimers (</legal/disclaimers>)
 - ☒ Acceptable Use Policy (</legal/acceptable-use>)
 - ☒ Attorney Agreement (</legal/attorney-agreement>)
 - ☒ Information Release Policy (</legal/information-release>)
 - ☒ Compliance Page (</legal/compliance>)
- ☐ **Legal Review**
 - ☐ Have attorney review all legal pages
 - ☐ Update contact information in legal pages
 - ☐ Verify all disclaimers are accurate
 - ☐ Ensure GDPR compliance language is correct (if serving EU users)

5. Security Hardening

- ☐ **Security Headers** ☒ (Already Configured)
 - ☒ Content-Security-Policy
 - ☒ X-Frame-Options
 - ☒ X-Content-Type-Options
 - ☒ HSTS
 - ☒ Referrer-Policy
- ☐ **Security Review**
 - ☐ Review all API endpoints for proper authentication
 - ☐ Verify rate limiting is working
 - ☐ Test SQL injection prevention
 - ☐ Test XSS prevention
 - ☐ Review admin access controls
 - ☐ Verify audit logging is working
- ☐ **Secrets Management**
 - ☐ Verify no secrets are committed to git
 - ☐ Review [.gitignore](#) includes [.env*](#) files
 - ☐ Ensure all secrets are in Vercel environment variables (not code)

6. Testing & Quality Assurance

- ☐ **Critical User Flows**
 - ☐ Attorney sign-up and onboarding
 - ☐ Attorney sign-in
 - ☐ Admin sign-in

- ☐ Client invitation creation
 - ☐ Client policy upload via invite
 - ☐ QR code update flow
 - ☐ Document upload and storage
 - ☐ Receipt generation and download
 - ☐ Contract acceptance flow (Base Tier)
 - ☐ Tier upgrade flows
- ☐ **API Testing**
 - ☐ Test all API endpoints with proper authentication
 - ☐ Test error handling and edge cases
 - ☐ Verify rate limiting works
 - ☐ Test file upload limits and validation
- ☐ **Database Testing**
 - ☐ Test database migrations on production-like environment
 - ☐ Verify data integrity constraints
 - ☐ Test backup and restore procedures
- ☐ **Performance Testing**
 - ☐ Load test critical endpoints
 - ☐ Verify database query performance
 - ☐ Test file upload/download speeds
 - ☐ Check page load times

7. Monitoring & Observability

- ☐ **Error Tracking** ☒ (Sentry Configured)
 - ☒ Sentry DSN configured
 - ☐ Verify Sentry is capturing errors in production
 - ☐ Set up error alerts/notifications
 - ☐ Configure error sampling rate for production
- ☐ **Application Monitoring**
 - ☐ Set up uptime monitoring (e.g., UptimeRobot, Pingdom)
 - ☐ Configure health check endpoint (</api/health>)
 - ☐ Set up performance monitoring
 - ☐ Configure log aggregation (if needed)
- ☐ **Database Monitoring**
 - ☐ Set up database connection monitoring
 - ☐ Configure slow query alerts
 - ☐ Monitor database size and growth

8. Deployment Configuration

- ☐ **Vercel Setup**
 - ☐ Connect GitHub repository to Vercel
 - ☐ Configure build command: `prisma generate && next build`
 - ☐ Configure install command: `npm install`
 - ☐ Set up production environment variables
 - ☐ Configure preview deployments (staging)
 - ☐ Set up deployment protection rules
 - ☐ **CI/CD Pipeline**
 - ☐ Verify GitHub Actions workflows are working
 - ☐ Test deployment process
 - ☐ Configure automatic migrations (if using)
 - ☐ Set up deployment notifications
 - ☐ **Build Verification**
 - ☐ Run `npm run build` locally and verify no errors
 - ☐ Run `npm run typecheck` and verify no TypeScript errors
 - ☐ Run `npm run lint` and fix any linting errors
 - ☐ Verify Prisma Client generates correctly
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🔴 IMPORTANT (Should Complete Before Launch)

9. Content & Copy Review

- ☐ **Marketing Copy**
 - ☐ Review all public-facing copy for accuracy
 - ☐ Verify all links work correctly
 - ☐ Check for typos and grammar errors
 - ☐ Ensure compliance language is correct (NAIC/MIB disclaimers)
- ☐ **User-Facing Messages**
 - ☐ Review error messages for clarity
 - ☐ Review success messages
 - ☐ Review email templates
 - ☐ Test email deliverability

10. Documentation

- ☐ **User Documentation**
 - ☐ Create user guide for attorneys
 - ☐ Create client-facing instructions
 - ☐ Document common workflows
- ☐ **Technical Documentation**

- ☒ README.md exists
- ☒ Deployment documentation exists
- ☐ API documentation (if exposing APIs)
- ☐ Database schema documentation

11. Backup & Disaster Recovery

- ☐ **Backup Strategy**
 - ☐ Configure automated database backups
 - ☐ Test backup restoration
 - ☐ Document backup procedures
 - ☐ Set backup retention policy
- ☐ **Disaster Recovery Plan**
 - ☐ Document recovery procedures
 - ☐ Test recovery scenarios
 - ☐ Identify recovery time objectives (RTO)
 - ☐ Identify recovery point objectives (RPO)

12. Performance Optimization

- ☐ **Frontend Performance**
 - ☐ Optimize images (Next.js Image component)
 - ☐ Enable Next.js production optimizations
 - ☐ Test page load speeds
 - ☐ Verify Core Web Vitals
- ☐ **Backend Performance**
 - ☐ Review database query performance
 - ☐ Add database indexes where needed
 - ☐ Optimize API response times
 - ☐ Configure caching where appropriate

13. Billing & Payments (If Enabled)

- ☐ **Stripe Configuration**
 - ☐ Set up production Stripe account
 - ☐ Configure products and pricing
 - ☐ Test payment flows
 - ☐ Verify webhook handling
 - ☐ Test subscription management
 - ☐ Test upgrade/downgrade flows
- ☐ **Billing Features**
 - ☐ Test contract acceptance flow

- ☐ Test tier upgrade modals
- ☐ Verify billing events ledger is working
- ☐ Test active estate counting

NICE TO HAVE (Can Complete Post-Launch)

14. Analytics & Tracking

- ☐ Set up Google Analytics or similar
- ☐ Configure conversion tracking
- ☐ Set up user behavior analytics
- ☐ Configure privacy-compliant tracking (GDPR)

15. SEO Optimization ☒ (Already Implemented)

- ☒ Meta tags and descriptions
- ☒ Open Graph tags
- ☒ Twitter Cards
- ☒ Structured data (JSON-LD)
- ☒ Sitemap (</sitemap.xml>)
- ☒ Robots.txt
- ☐ Verify sitemap is accessible
- ☐ Submit sitemap to search engines

16. Additional Features

- ☐ Email templates customization
- ☐ Custom branding/white-labeling
- ☐ Advanced search features
- ☐ Export functionality (CSV, Excel)
- ☐ Bulk operations
- ☐ Mobile app (future)

17. Support Infrastructure

- ☐ Set up support email/help desk
- ☐ Create support documentation
- ☐ Set up FAQ page
- ☐ Configure contact forms

Pre-Launch Verification

Final Checks (24-48 Hours Before Launch)

- ☐ **Environment Verification**

```
# Run these commands to verify setup:
npm run typecheck      # No TypeScript errors
npm run lint           # No linting errors
npm run build          # Successful build
npx prisma migrate status # All migrations applied
```

- ☐ **Security Audit**
 - ☐ Review all environment variables
 - ☐ Verify no test credentials in production
 - ☐ Check for exposed secrets
 - ☐ Review access logs
 - ☐ **Performance Check**
 - ☐ Run Lighthouse audit
 - ☐ Test on multiple devices/browsers
 - ☐ Verify mobile responsiveness
 - ☐ Check page load times
 - ☐ **User Acceptance Testing**
 - ☐ Test complete user journey
 - ☐ Verify all features work as expected
 - ☐ Test error scenarios
 - ☐ Verify email delivery
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Launch Day Checklist

Launch Day (Day 0)

- ☐ **Pre-Launch (Morning)**
 - ☐ Final environment variable check
 - ☐ Run final database migrations
 - ☐ Verify all services are connected
 - ☐ Test critical paths one more time
- ☐ **Launch (Afternoon)**
 - ☐ Deploy to production
 - ☐ Verify deployment succeeded
 - ☐ Test production site functionality
 - ☐ Monitor error logs
 - ☐ Verify email delivery
- ☐ **Post-Launch (Evening)**
 - ☐ Monitor error rates

- ☐ Check performance metrics
- ☐ Review user activity
- ☐ Address any immediate issues

Post-Launch (Week 1)

- ☐ Monitor error rates daily
- ☐ Review user feedback
- ☐ Address critical bugs
- ☐ Optimize based on usage patterns
- ☐ Review security logs

 Emergency Contacts

Document key contacts for production issues:

- ☐ Database administrator
- ☐ Hosting provider support
- ☐ Payment processor support
- ☐ Email service support
- ☐ Legal counsel

 Quick Reference Links

- **Vercel Dashboard:** <https://vercel.com/dashboard>
- **Supabase Dashboard:** <https://supabase.com/dashboard>
- **Clerk Dashboard:** <https://dashboard.clerk.com>
- **Stripe Dashboard:** <https://dashboard.stripe.com>
- **Sentry Dashboard:** <https://sentry.io>
- **Resend Dashboard:** <https://resend.com>

☒ Completion Status

Critical Items: 0/8 completed

Important Items: 0/5 completed

Nice to Have: 0/4 completed

Estimated Time to Launch: 2-4 weeks (depending on testing and legal review)

 Notes

- Most infrastructure is already in place
- Focus on environment configuration and testing
- Legal review may take 1-2 weeks
- Testing should be thorough before launch
- Consider a soft launch with limited users first

